Deployment Guide

Owner: Platform Engineering

1. Environments

Code moves through three environments: development, staging and production. Staging mirrors production and uses anonymised data only.

2. Release process

Pull requests to production need approval from two engineers. Production deployments are allowed from Tuesday to Thursday between 09:00 and 16:00 CET. Deployments on Fridays and public holidays are not allowed, except for SEV1 fixes.

3. Rollback

Every deployment is monitored for 10 minutes. If the error rate rises above 2 percent, the deployment is rolled back automatically. Engineers can also roll back manually with the command bl deploy rollback.

4. Feature flags

New features are released behind feature flags. A flag must be removed from the code within 60 days after the feature is fully rolled out.

5. Database migrations

Database migrations must be backward compatible and are applied before the new code is deployed. Every migration is reviewed by the database owner of the service.

6. Secrets

Secrets are never stored in configuration files or source code. Services read their secrets from the central vault at start-up.